If the boot fits

Student: ..... Class: .....

Forensic scientists work together to investigate and make a deduction based on evidence provided. You will use the photograph of the bloody footprint which is evidence in the ‘Coffee shop shoot out’ case.

The ability to observe every detail at a crime scene is one of the most important skills a forensic scientist has. The evidence could be as large as the body of a victim or as small as the DNA attached to a single strand of hair from the suspect. All of the evidence, no matter how big or small, can be used to piece together what occurred at the crime scene.

Imagine that you are a forensic scientist at the ‘Coffee shop shoot out’ crime scene. You have been sent by the senior forensics scientist to investigate the bloodied footprint. Examine the evidence and complete the following questions.

1. How fast was the person moving? What evidence did you use to decide on the answer?

.....

2. What is the size of the footprint? What size shoe could this be?

.....

3. What type of shoe has left the footprint? How can you tell?

.....

.....

.....

4. Is the footprint close to or far away from the source of the blood? How did you decide on your answer?

.....

.....

5. Does the footprint belong to a male or female? Explain.

.....

.....

Extension

How can a footprint provide other evidence depending on what substance the print is left in?

.....

.....

.....

© John Wiley & Sons Australia, Ltd